



A Letter to Foxy Developers

A look at what makes Mozilla Firefox the most developer friendly browser around, and how you can get the most out of the community-developed Mozilla Firefox.

Mozilla Firefox is by far the most popular browser amongst Web developers. There is a reason for this, and in the following pages we will explore what exactly it is. But to understand why developers love Firefox, we need to understand why a developer loves any browser in the first place.

What is the love about?

The time and effort invested by any Web developer on a Web application (be it a website, or a product) is divided into a number of common activities. These include developing the back-end systems like the database, the application logic, transaction management, security and stability. Then comes developing the front-end systems (what we use as consumers) —the user interface and experience.

The back-end work is taken care of by server software, and can be scripted in a range of languages like Python, Ruby, PHP and ASP.net. It primarily takes care of all the processing the application will do once the user provides the input (e.g., clicking on a *submit* button, selecting an item from a drop-down list, and so on).

The front-end stuff is written in HTML, CSS, JavaScript and associated technologies. It is what the user sees and experiences. It is also what the browser will render on the user's system. It is also the layer where browsers work differently, and that influences how a specific Web application will perform in a specific browser.

Originally, when the Web was a simpler place to live in, there were only two major browsers: